



IDX G9 ENGLISH H STUDY GUIDE ISSUE S2

FINALS

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Finals Scope:

1. Vocabulary matching /10pt
2. Grammar /10pt
3. MCQ + short answers /20pt
4. SPACECAT Annotation /10pts
5. Essay /30pts

1. Vocabulary

- Tested based on rhetorical devices, here are the ones you NEED to know:

0. **Allusion:** an expression designed to call something to mind without mentioning it explicitly; an indirect or passing reference

“He collapsed in a fit of passion, outstretching his hands to the sky.” (Biblical allusion to Jesus’s crucifixion.)

1. **Hyperbole:** exaggerated statements or claims not meant to be taken literally

“I’m so hungry that I could eat a horse.”

2. **Euphemism:** a mild or indirect word or expression substituted for one considered to be too harsh or blunt when referring to something unpleasant or embarrassing

“He’s in a better place now.” (Instead of saying that someone has died.)

3. **Juxtaposition:** Two things being seen or placed close together with contrasting effect

“You’re hot and you’re cold, you’re yes and you’re no, you’re up and down...”

4. **Anecdote:** a short and interesting story relevant to the topic at hand, often an amusing event, often used to support or demonstrate some point, and may be used to make an audience laugh

5. **Oxymoron:** figure of speech in which two contradictory words are put side by side to form a phrase

“It is bittersweet that there is no more jumbo shrimp at the grocery store.”

6. **Repetition:** device that involves intentionally using a word or phrase for effect, two or more times in a speech or written work

- **Anaphora:** repetition at the beginning of a sentence or clauses that follow one another

“I declare that someday we will reach glory! I declare that one day we will hold heaven in our hands! I declare that the day is near, the day is at hand!”

- **Epistrophe:** repetition at the end of a sentence or clause

“And so men, I ask is this the end? This cannot be the end. If this is the end, then it will be the end on our own terms.”

7. **Parallelism:** Parallelism is a figure of speech in which two or more elements of a sentence (or series of sentences) have the same grammatical structure.

8. **Irony:** occurs when the intended meaning contrasts with the literal words (e.g., saying "What a great day!" during a storm). **Verbal irony** is sarcasm; **situational irony** involves unexpected outcomes

9. **Syntax:** is sentence structure—how word order, length, and complexity shape meaning. Short sentences create urgency; long ones suggest depth. For example, Hemingway’s terse syntax conveys bluntness, while Dickens’ winding sentences evoke richness.

2. Grammar

Tested on subject verb agreement, its probably gonna look like this:

Basic:

The cat (is/are) sleeping on the couch.

My friends (likes/like) to play soccer.

Each student (has/have) a textbook.

The news (was/were) surprising.

Neither the teacher nor the students (knows/know) the answer

Medium:

The team (are/is) arguing about the rules. (Collective noun → singular verb if acting as one unit.)

Either the books or the notebook (belong/belongs) to me. (Closest noun rules.)

Ten dollars (is/are) too much for a snack. (Amounts = singular.)

Physics (require/requires) strong math skills. (Academic subjects = singular.)

The jury (debate/debates) the verdict. (Collective noun → singular.)

HARD:

The list of items (is/are) on the table. (Hint: "List" = subject.)

Neither she nor her brothers (enjoy/enjoys) hiking. (Closest noun rules.)

The data (suggest/suggests) a problem.

Answer key:

1. 1. is | 2. like | 3. has | 4. was | 5. Know
2. 1. is | 2. belongs | 3. is | 4. requires | 5. Debates
3. 1. is | 2. enjoy | 3. suggest (formal)

The Secret of getting them all right:

1. Singular vs. Plural

- **Singular subject?** → **Singular verb** (*is, was, has, likes*).
- **Plural subject?** → **Plural verb** (*are, were, have, like*).
 - *The cat **is** sleeping.* (singular)
 - *My friends **like** soccer.* (plural)

2. Tricky Singulars

These **always** take singular verbs:

- **Uncountable stuff** (news, money, physics):
 - *The news **was** bad.*
 - *Ten dollars **is** too much.*
- **"Each," "neither," "either":**
 - *Each student **has** a book.*
 - *Neither the teacher nor the students **know** the answer.* (See Rule 5.)

3. Collective Nouns (Team, Jury, Class)

- Acting as **one unit?** → **Singular**.
 - *The team **is** winning.*
- Members doing their own thing? → **Plural** (more common in British English).
 - *The team **are** fighting.*

4. "Either/Or" & "Neither/Nor"

- **Verb agrees with the closest noun:**
 - *Either the books or the notebook **belongs** to me.* (notebook = singular)
 - *Neither she nor her brothers **enjoy** hiking.* (brothers = plural)

5. Ignore Prepositional Phrases

- The verb matches the **main subject**, not the extra words:
 - *The list of items **is** on the table.* (List = subject, not "items." List is singular and so we use "is")

6. Data & Media (Formal vs. Informal)

- **Data** is technically plural (*datum* = singular), but often treated as singular in informal usage.
 - Formal settings: *The data **suggest** a problem.*
 - Informal settings: *The data **shows/suggests** a problem.*

7. Academic Subjects & Titles

- Subjects like *physics, mathematics, economics* are **singular**.
 - *Physics **requires** math skills.*
- **Book/movie titles** are singular even if plural in form.
 - *"The Lord of the Rings" **is** my favorite book.*

Now go back and redo the questions with these laws, see if you get less wrong.

3. MCQ + short answers

We can't really do much for mcqs, but I guess logical fallacy may appear here:

Hasty Generalization

- Drawing a general conclusion based on insufficient, unrepresentative, or biased evidence.
- Example: "I met three rude New Yorkers, so all New Yorkers are rude." A small, possibly unrepresentative sample can't justify a broad claim about an entire group.

Red Herring

- Introducing an irrelevant topic to divert attention from the original argument (Emotionally charged distractions)
- Example: When discussing "Should we raise the minimum wage?", someone says, "But small businesses are struggling to survive." The struggle of small businesses may not directly relate to the minimum wage debate, shifting focus away from the core issue.

Slippery Slope

- Arguing that a minor action will inevitably lead to extreme, negative consequences without proving this chain of events.
- Example: "If we allow teens to use social media, they'll become addicted, neglect school, and ruin their futures." Assumes a drastic "slippery" sequence (social media → addiction → academic failure → ruined life) without evidence these steps are inevitable.

Genetic Fallacy

- Judging an idea or thing based on its origin (e.g., where it came from) rather than its actual merit.
- Example: "That policy is from a liberal think tank, so it must be bad." Dismisses the policy's value by

attacking its source, not analyzing its content.

Circular Argument

- Using the conclusion as the premise to prove itself (the argument goes in a circle, offering no real proof)
- Example: “The Bible is true because God wrote it, and we know God wrote it because the Bible says so.” The conclusion (“The Bible is true”) relies on the premise (“God wrote it”), which relies back on the conclusion—no external evidence is used.

Ad Populum

- Claiming an idea is true or good simply because many people believe it (appealing to popularity)
- Example: “Lots of people buy this diet pill, so it must work.” Popularity doesn’t equal effectiveness—many people could be wrong or misled.

Straw Man

- Misrepresenting or exaggerating an opponent’s argument to make it easier to attack
- Example: Person A: “We should limit fossil fuel use to fight climate change.” Person B: “So you want to shut down all industries and destroy the economy? That’s crazy!” Person B distorts Person A’s reasonable claim into an extreme, fictional “straw man” argument to dismiss it.

Moral Equivalence

- Equating minor moral issues with major, serious ones, creating a false sense of equal importance
- Example: “Lying about your age online is just as bad as committing fraud.” Minimizes the severity of fraud by comparing it to a trivial lie—their moral weights differ drastically.

Either/Or (False Dilemma)

- Presenting only two extreme options as the only possibilities, ignoring middle grounds or alternatives
- Example: “Either we ban all cars, or we let pollution destroy the planet.” Ignores solutions like improving public transport, electric cars, or emissions regulations—there’s more than two choices.

Begging the Claim

- Assuming the conclusion is true within the premise, so the argument “begs” the question (circular reasoning in a simpler form)
- Example: “This product is the best because it’s superior to all others.” “Superior” just repeats “the best”—the premise assumes the conclusion without proof.

Post Hoc Ergo Propter Hoc

- Assuming that because Event B happened after Event A, A caused B (ignoring other factors)

- Example: “I wore my lucky socks, and then our team won—so the socks caused the win!” Correlation (socks → win) doesn’t prove causation—there could be other reasons (team skill, opponent errors, etc.).

Ad Hominem

- Attacking a person’s character, appearance, or background instead of debating their argument.
- Example: “Don’t trust his tax policy—he’s a dishonest person.” Dismisses the policy by attacking the person, not addressing the policy’s merits.

Non-sequitur

- A conclusion that logically doesn’t follow from the premises (no connection between the argument’s parts).
- Example: “She’s good at math, so she’ll be a great artist.” Math skills and artistic talent are unrelated—there’s no logical link between the premise and conclusion.

Let’s do some practice

1. My last two math teachers were terrible, so all math teachers must be bad.
2. We shouldn't worry about climate change—after all, there's still poverty and war.
3. If we allow students to redo their homework, soon they'll expect to retake every test and never take school seriously again.
4. That research comes from a conservative organization, so it can't be trusted.
5. The Bible is true because it says it's the word of God, and we know God is real because the Bible says so.
6. You shouldn't vote for her; she cheated on her boyfriend in college.
7. Everyone at school is buying this new energy drink. It must be the healthiest option.
8. You want to reduce military spending? So you want the country to be defenseless and overrun by enemies!
9. Littering is just as bad as dumping toxic waste into the ocean.

10. He got into college after buying that lucky keychain. The keychain must have helped him!

Answers:

1. Hasty Generalization. This person draws a broad conclusion about all math teachers based on just two examples. That's too small a sample to justify such a sweeping claim.
2. Red Herring. The speaker introduces a different issue (poverty and war) to distract from the original topic (climate change), diverting the conversation instead of addressing it directly.
3. Slippery Slope. This argument assumes that a small action (redoing homework) will inevitably lead to extreme consequences, without evidence that such a chain reaction is likely.
4. Genetic Fallacy. The argument attacks the origin (where the research comes from) instead of evaluating the actual quality or truth of the research itself.
5. Circular Argument. The claim (the Bible is true) is supported by reasoning that loops back to itself. No external evidence is provided—just circular reasoning.
6. Ad Hominem. This attacks the person's character instead of her qualifications or political views. Her past behavior is unrelated to the argument at hand.
7. Ad Populum. Just because something is popular doesn't mean it's good or true. Popularity isn't valid evidence for effectiveness or healthiness.
8. Straw Man. The speaker distorts the opponent's argument into an exaggerated or extreme version (wanting no defense at all) in order to make it easier to attack.
9. Moral Equivalence. This compares a relatively minor wrong (littering) to a major environmental crime (dumping toxic waste), falsely suggesting they are equally serious.
10. Post Hoc Ergo Propter Hoc. This falsely assumes a cause-effect relationship just because one event followed another. There's no evidence the keychain caused the admission.

So let's prepare for short answers, according to the English teachers, you'll be given a short speech and asked short questions based on it.

For example: In this part “”, what is the speaker using? Why would the speaker choose that rhetoric device? What are the effects of this rhetoric device?

What you have to do is:

1. Identify the device
2. Explain why its used
3. Describe the effect

Here are some example questions to help you out:

"Ask not what your country can do for you—ask what you can do for your country." (JFK)

What device is used? Why? Effect?

*"The speaker uses **antithesis** (contrasting ideas)."*

"This highlights civic duty by flipping the perspective."

"It makes the message memorable and challenges the audience to act."

"We are the change. We are the hope. We are the future."

*"The speaker uses **anaphora** (repeating 'We are')."*

By using anaphora the speaker builds momentum and empowers the audience to feel collective responsibility."

3. SPACECAT analysis

Not much to say, practice makes perfect, redo some of your spacecat worksheets.

S-Speaker

- Who is the speaker/writer? What do we know about them? What can you tell or what do you know about the speaker that helps you understand the point of view expressed?

P-Purpose

- The goal of the speaker/author?
- Examples:
 - ❖ support a cause
 - ❖ Promote a change
 - ❖ Refute a theory
 - ❖ Stimulate interest
 - ❖ Win argument
 - ❖ Arouse sympathy
 - ❖ Provoke anger

A-Audience

- Who does the speaker address and why? Do they indicate a specific audience? What assumptions exist

in the text about the intended audience?

- If analyzing a historical text ---> talking about the original audience/reader

C-Context

- What is the time and place of this piece? What is happening in the world as it relates to the subject of the speech or the speaker/writer?

E-Exigence

- The circumstances surrounding the original delivery of the speech and/or publication of the piece
- What was the spark or catalyst that moved the speaker/writer to act/write? How did that event impact the speaker/writer?

C-Choices

- What are the rhetorical choices that the speaker/writer makes in the speech? Think about overall structure, devices, diction, syntax, etc.

A-Appeals

- Which of the three rhetorical appeals are present in the text? Where? Why?
- Ethos
 - ❖ Appeals of logic
 - ❖ Refers to the writer's credibility and character, his/her presentation of "self"
 - ❖ How the writer/speaker establishes trust and respect, with his/her audience
 - ❖ Q: Is the writer/speaker ethical enough to be reliable?
- Pathos
 - ❖ Appeals of emotion
 - ❖ The use of words and images to evoke emotions such as fear, anger, empathy, jealousy, pity, love, etc.
 - ❖ May include:
 - ✧ Language that appeals to the senses eg: imagery
 - ✧ A bias or prejudice
 - ✧ An anecdote eg: a story
 - ✧ Connotative language
 - ✧ Figurative language
 - ✧ Informal language
 - ❖ Q: How does the speaker try to make the audience empathize with the piece? (What makes you feel?)
- Logos
 - ❖ Appeals of credibility
 - ❖ The use of research, facts, statistics, expert testimony, witnesses, scientific data, etc.
 - ❖ Q: Does the argument make sense? Does it evoke a cognitive, rational response?

T-Tone

- Which of the three rhetorical appeals (ethos, logos, pathos) are present in the text? Where? Why?

4. Essay

1 intro+ 2 PEELs + 1 conclusion

Remember to add in some context in intro, for ex: This speech was given by... To... because...